QM47400 · Spring 2027 · Milestone 03

Project Draft Abstract

DUE	**Sunday, February 21, 2027, 11:59 PM ET**
OPENS	Monday, February 15, 2027
SUBMIT	One PDF per group, uploaded by one member: `NN_abstract.pdf` (a title and an abstract of about 250 words)
GRADING	30 points: three criteria, 10 points each

What this milestone is for

An abstract is the short summary people read before deciding whether to stop at your poster. This draft becomes the abstract of your conference application in Milestone 05, so write it for a mixed audience of faculty, classmates and industry professionals: clear enough for a non-specialist, precise enough for an expert.

What to do

Write two things.

1. **A project title.** Concise and informative, it should capture the project and its prediction goal. For example: *"Predicting Customer Churn: A Data-Driven Approach to Enhancing Retention Strategies."*
2. **A draft abstract of about 250 words** that covers:
   - the prediction problem, framed as a clear question, with a question mark;
   - your prediction goal and why it matters;
   - your **real data**: the dataset's original provider and what real-world observations it contains;
   - your methods and tools: how you prepare the data, the analytical methods, and the software;
   - your key findings or expected contributions;
   - the broader implications for business practice or for the field.

Remember the real-data rule: the project must use data collected or observed from an actual real-world process. Synthetic, simulated, artificially generated and AI-generated datasets are not eligible, and neither is the synthetic Bank Churn data of the Course Case Competition.

This is a *draft*, written before your models exist. Your final numbers come in Milestones 06 and 08, so state preliminary or expected findings now; you will sharpen them for the poster.

What to submit

One member uploads `NN_abstract.pdf` for the whole group, with the title and the abstract, for example `03_abstract.pdf`.

How it is graded

Thirty points: three criteria, each worth 10 points, scored as exemplary (9–10), proficient (7–8), developing (5–6) or beginning (0–4).

- **Project title:** clear, concise and compelling, and it captures the project and its prediction goal.
- **Abstract content:** well organized; summarizes the goal, the eligible real data and its original provider, the methods, the key findings and the broader implications. A synthetic or generated dataset, or missing core parts, falls in the beginning band.

- **Writing quality and polish:** clear academic language that a diverse audience can follow, free of errors, and carefully proofread.

Tips

- Keep it close to 250 words: you will paste it into the conference application.
- Do not put author names inside the abstract text; the application asks for authors separately.
- Use the feedback from Milestones 01 and 02.
- Read it aloud once. If a sentence is hard to say, it is hard to read.

The Final Project Overview PDF has every date, the meeting rounds, and how the project is graded.